



UPSC CSE 2026/27



ANTHROPOLOGY OPTIONAL FOUNDATION

Assignment



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7+ Years Experience

Socio-cultural Assignment Questions for Anthro Foundation Batch

Answer length instructions:

- **10 marks:** Write about 150 words. This should fill 2 UPSC style pages, with 15 lines per page. Total about 30 lines.
- **15 marks:** Write about 250 words. This should fill 3 UPSC style pages, with 15 lines per page. Total about 45 lines.
- **20 marks:** Write about 350 words. This should fill 4 UPSC style pages, with 15 lines per page. Total about 60 lines.

Deadline for Assignment Submissions- 12th June 2026

Instructions to submit your assignment:

- Submit all the assignment questions in one single **scanned PDF file** (no photos, please).
- **File name:** FullName_AFA batch X_TopicName.pdf.
(The "AFA" tag helps me identify that it is an Anthropology Foundation Assignment. Please fill "X" with your batch number.)
- **Compress the file** if it is large. I usually receive neat scanned copies under **1 MB**, this should be manageable.
- Also send your **payment receipt**, so we can verify that you are part of one of our programs, and ensure your submissions are prioritised before anyone else's mails.
- Tell me a bit about yourself. Your name, where you are from, graduation subject and year, date of birth, and one interesting thing about you. I enjoy knowing who is on the other side of the answer sheet, it makes this more than just marks and margins.
- Try to write **15 lines per page**.
- Send everything in **one single email thread** from now till the end of the batch. Please do not send multiple mails. All your information from the start of the batch till course completion should be in the same thread. This helps me track your progress and minimises clutter.
- Once you have sent all that, I will take a look and get back to you. Thank you.

Additional Instructions for Submission:

- At the **beginning left margin of each answer**, please make a note of how many scholar names you have incorporated. Try to maximise the number of relevant scholars wherever possible.
- The **starting pages of your assignment** should include short notes covering:
 - The **entire Socio-Cultural Anthropology** portion of the syllabus.
- If the above instructions are not followed, the work will not be considered a valid submission for evaluation. So please make sure you follow them fully and carefully.

All the best. Keep writing.

Socio-cultural Anthro (SCA) Assignment questions:

1. Write a note on Culture and Society 10 M
2. Explain ethnocentrism and cultural relativism. 10 M
3. Write a note on social stratification. 15 M
4. What are the bases of Social Stratification? 10 M
5. Write a note on Culture and Civilization. 10 M
6. Write a note on Social institutions. 10 M
7. Write a note on Social Groups. 10 M
8. Discuss the different forms of marriage with examples. 10 M
9. Write a note on Fraternal polyandry. 10 M

10. Write a note on incest taboo. 10 M
11. Hypergamy and Hypogamy. 10 M
12. Write a note on Ways of acquiring a spouse in simple societies. 15 M
13. Is there a universal definition of marriage? Comment on the universality of the institution of marriage? 20 M
14. Discuss the Economic aspects of Marriage. 10 M
15. Divorce and dissolution. 10 M
16. Household and domestic group. 10 M
17. Write a note on different forms of family. 15 M
18. Is there any universal definition of family and comment on universality of institution of family? 20 M
19. Discuss the impact of Urbanisation and feminist movement on family. 10 M
20. Kinship Terminology and its determinants. 20M
21. Write a note on Forms of Descent groups. 10 M
22. Write a note on lineage and clan. 10M
23. Write about filiation and complementary filiation. 10M
24. Write a note on Segmentary lineage. 10 M
25. Explain the various types of Descent. 20 M
26. Bilateral and Bilineal descent. 10 M
27. Describe the cardinal points of Descent and Alliance theories. 20 M
28. Discuss the meaning, scope, and relevance of Economic Anthropology. 10 M
29. Differentiate between Economics and Economic Anthropology. 10M
30. Critically discuss the formalist and substantivist approaches in the context of Economic Anthropology. 15M
31. Discuss the principles governing Production, Distribution and Exchange in simple societies. 20 M
32. With the help of appropriate examples, explain the various forms of the exchange system. 20M
33. Describe the different stages of Economic Development. 20M.
34. Write a note on Hunting and gathering societies. 10 M
35. Write a note on Pastoralism. 10M
36. Write a note on Horticulture in simple societies. 10M
37. Write a note on Shifting cultivation in simple societies. 10M
38. Write a note on Agriculture in simple societies. 10M
39. Kula ring. 10M
40. Potlatch. 10M
41. Discuss the impact of globalization in the tribal economy. 20M
42. Discuss the meaning, scope, and relevance of Political Anthropology. 10 M
43. Band and Tribal societies. 10 M
44. Differentiate between state and stateless society. 10M
45. Differentiate between egalitarian and non-egalitarian societies. 10M
46. Describe the evolution of Political systems (or different types of political organisations). 20 M
47. Explain the significance of power, authority and legitimacy. 15M
48. Discuss different Social Control Mechanisms in simple societies. 15 M
49. How does customary law function in tribal society and discuss its different sources? 15M
50. Customary law Vs Modern law. 10 M
51. Explain the oath and ordeal type of dispute resolution evidence. 15M
52. Discuss the nature of law and justice (including peaceful and violent means of settling disputes) in simple societies citing suitable examples. 20 M
53. Critically examine different Anthropological approaches to the study of Religion. 20M
54. Sacred and Profane. 10 M
55. Myth and Ritual. 10 M

- 56. Discuss the different traditional forms of Religion in simple societies. 20 M
- 57. Magic. 10M
- 58. Religion and Magic. 10 M
- 59. Science and Magic. 10 M
- 60. Religion and Science. 10M
- 61. Describe the different Magico-religious functionaries. 20 M



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